



THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

The Proven Mental Program
to a Life of Wealth

Wallace D. Wattles



The Big “So What”

First published in 1910, this was one of the earliest self-help books that explained how to acquire wealth in a scientific way based on metaphysical concepts. Wattles promises that **if you truly grasp the ideas in this book and apply them like a scientific formula, it will be the only book on getting rich that you’ll ever need to read.**



Introduction

This book is based on Wattles’ study of philosophers like Descartes, Spinoza, Leibniz, Schopenhauer, Hegel and Emerson. Wattles focuses only on the practical insights you’d need to get rich, without going into detail on how metaphysics works. He urges that you take the facts presented in the book as true. If you wish to do further research on your own, he recommends the works by Hegel and Emerson.



Defining wealth. Richness in this book refers to having **everything you can possible want in life.**

- Being successful involves much more than money. It’s about being who you want to be and living to your full potential, which also includes contribution, fulfillment, appreciation of beauty etc.
- However, it is important to have money. Our society is structured such that we need money to buy, use and organize things. When you have lots of money and can put it to good use, you can multiply your growth and impact.



Getting rich is a science. According to Wattles, getting rich is an exact science. It works like a set of algorithms, much like

KEY QUOTES

“Getting rich is the result of doing things in a Certain Way...any man or woman who can do things in that way can become rich.”

“The man who owns all he wants for the living of all the life he is capable of living is rich.”

“In order to know more, do more, and be more we must have more.”

“Wherever there is unexpressed possibility, or function not performed, there is unsatisfied desire.”

the mathematical laws of addition and subtraction. *By applying the science in this book, anyone can get rich.*

- Your ability to become rich does not depend on your environment, talent, ability to save money, nor your choice of business or profession. Two people with similar circumstances or talent can end up with vastly different levels of wealth.
- Instead, it depends solely on whether you think and act in accordance with the laws of getting rich. To test if this law is real, you need to apply it yourself.

The book is presented in 17 short chapters. In this summary, we've organized the key ideas into 3 key parts: Establishing the Truths, Thinking in the Certain Way and Acting in the Certain Way.

Part 1: Embracing the Truths

The Science of Thinking Rich begins with you fully embracing several truths, so you can think and act in accordance with these truths to create massive wealth.

 At the most fundamental level, everything in this universe is made of the same "Original Substance".

- It is formless, supremely intelligent and permeates everything around us—including organic and inorganic things and the spaces between them.
- It is behind the very creation of this universe; it is everywhere, infused in and connected to everything.
- Wattles uses many terms interchangeably to describe this substance, including "Formless Substance", "Thinking Substance", "Original Substance", "Supreme intelligence", "Living Presence", "God" and "Nature". *For this summary, we'll refer to it mainly as the Source, and occasionally as Nature or God.*
- The Source is pro-life and pro-creation. It flows naturally toward anything and anyone that supports life, creation and a fuller expression of life.

KEY QUOTES

"You can become what you want to be only by making use of things, and you can have the free use of things only as you become rich enough to buy them."

"The universe is a great Living Presence, always moving inherently toward more life and fuller functioning."

"It is the nature of intelligence to enlarge itself, and of consciousness to seek to extend its boundaries and find fuller expression."

➔ **Thoughts trigger the process of creation.** Every thought leaves an impression in the Source, and triggers the process of giving form to that thought.

- If you think of a house, the form of the house is impressed upon the Source. It automatically sets the wheels in motion to create the house. This could be in the form of changes to the commerce or construction industries, or the formation of raw materials required to someday build that house.
- Such creation generally flows along existing paths/lines of growth and action.
- The results are not instantaneous. For example, the thought of an oak tree will immediately trigger the process of its creation, though it may take centuries for that tree to be fully formed.



Human beings are “thinking centers”. Mankind can originate thought—when we imagine things, we form them in our minds and impress these thoughts on the Source. This triggers the process of creation.

- Every action you take, everything you create with your hands and every item that you see all originates from an invisible thought.
- The only way to create tangible wealth is to begin with your thoughts.



Part 2: Thinking in the Certain Way

We'll now take a closer look at how the Source works and **how to think in the specific way that brings wealth to you.**



Create, Don't Compete



Most people have the **wrong perspective about wealth**. They see it as a finite resource that's limited and/or controlled by certain people or institutions.

KEY QUOTES

“No thought of form can be impressed upon Original Substance without causing the creation of the form.”

“Every form and process you see in nature is the visible expression of a thought in Original Substance.”

“The Creative Power within us makes us into the image of that to which we give our attention.”

“All the forms that man fashions with his hands must first exist in his thought; he cannot shape a thing until he has thought that thing.”

“Nature is an inexhaustible storehouse of riches; the supply will never run short.”

- Thus, they are afraid to lose out and fear that others will steal their riches or opportunities.
- They try to get more at the expense of others, competing or even taking advantage of others for their own gains.

 In reality, there is more than enough for everyone.

- The Source is of infinite supply and can never be depleted. Thus, there is always more than enough riches for everyone.
- No one can monopolize opportunity or wealth. There are always opportunities around you, even though the form of such opportunities constantly evolves. If you follow the rules in this book, flow with the tide and capture available opportunities, no one can keep you down or withhold riches from you.

 **Abundance for all.** Earlier, we explained that the Source is pro-life and pro-creation. It does *not* take something away from one party to give to another. Instead, it moves in a way that gives more life to *all*.

- Do not seek riches solely for *personal gratification* (i.e. for your own selfish enjoyment or interests), engage in *rivalry* (i.e. compete with others), nor *charity* (i.e. sacrifice yourself solely for the good of others).
- Do seek riches in a way that creates more for you *and* others. To do so, you must look beyond what's visible. Focus on creating with the Source, which will never run out and cannot be taken away from you.

 **You have the right to be rich.** Remove all notions that money is bad or that God frowns upon.

- Paul said that “it is God that worketh in you to will and to do”. The Source, God, Nature or the Universe (whichever term you relate to) wants you to be rich and have more. It wants you to become the vessel through which it channels creative energy.
- The key to creating wealth while staying in harmony with the Source is to benefit others as well as yourself.

KEY QUOTES

“There is abundance of opportunity for the man who will go with the tide, instead of trying to swim against it.”

“No man is kept poor because opportunity has been taken away from him.”

“Remember that extreme altruism is no better and no nobler than extreme selfishness; both are mistakes.”

“You are to become a creator, not a competitor; you are going to get what you want, but in such a way that when you get it every other man will have more than he has now.”

“Desire is possibility seeking expression, or function seeking performance.”



The secret to creating value for all involved is to give more to others in “use value” than what you take in “cash value”.

- For example, if you sell an Eskimo a famous piece of art (worth \$2mil) for \$200, you are not creating value, for he has no real use for it. However, if you sell him a gun or heater for the same amount, you are adding value. It's always possible to transact in a way that creates more value for everyone involved.
- The value of knowledge (like the ideas in this book) can be worth much more to the user than the cash value of the book. Likewise, you can set up your business to give your employees opportunities to grow and make much more money than just the cash salary you give them.



Faith and Gratitude



Once you've impressed your thought on the Source, have the faith that your request will definitely arrive. Claim it as if it's already yours.



There's no need to keep worrying or talking about your request or how it will be delivered. The Source is connected to all things, and knows the best way to make things happen in a way that benefits everyone involved. It may create certain events or bring certain people to you, all of which jointly deliver what you want.



What you must do is to think in harmony with the Source, have faith, and act in a Certain Way (which we'll cover in the next section). To build your faith, you can make progressively bigger requests, rebuilding your vision as you do so.



The Law of Gratitude says that action and reaction are always equal and move in opposite directions. When you offer gratitude in response to a gift, the forces of giving and receiving are in harmony.

- The stronger your gratitude, the stronger the reaction from the Source, and the faster good things come your way.
- It's common for people to cut off their connection with God or the Source once they get what they want. They fail to

KEY QUOTES

“Give every man more in use value than you take from him in cash value; then you are adding to the life of the world by every business transaction.”

“You will not need to deal with (others) unfairly; you do not have to give something for nothing, but can give to every man more than you take from him.”

“The answer to prayer is not according to your faith while you are talking, but according to your faith while you are working.”

“To permit your mind to dwell upon the inferior is to become inferior and to surround yourself with inferior things.”

acknowledge their gifts with gratitude, or even complain about what they've received. If you feel discontented or focus on your inadequacy, you impress these thoughts on the Source and bring them to you.



Gratitude and faith reinforce each other: when you are grateful, you expect more good things (faith), which brings them to you.

- Develop the habit of being grateful for every good thing (big or small) that comes to you.
- Don't waste time and energy feeling upset about what you lack, nor complain about others' inadequacies or mistakes.



Have a Clear, Consistent Mental Picture



In order for the Source to deliver what you want, you must first hold and transmit a clear, precise mental picture of it.

- It's not enough to have a vague idea that you want to "live better" or have "more money".
- Consider what exactly you want, and go over it in great detail to sharpen your mental picture. For example, crystallize every detail of your desired house, including its surrounding and furnishings.



Once you have a clear mental image of what you want, hold it consistently in your mind.

- Most people never get down to crystallizing what they want, or they get distracted easily by other things. To form and hold a clear, consistent image of something, you must have a strong desire for it.
- Formulate your vision in vivid images, not tons of words. Without clarity, no amount of contemplation, prayers, or affirmations will work.
- Create a self-reinforcing cycle: crystallize a definite mental picture of what you want, constantly replay the details and sensations so it strengthens your desire and makes it easier to hold the picture in your mind.

KEY QUOTES

"You can never get rich, or start the creative power into action, by sending out unformed longings and vague desires."

"Unless you really want to get rich, so that the desire is strong enough to hold your thoughts directed to the purpose as the magnetic pole holds the needle of the compass, it will hardly be worthwhile for you to try to carry out the instructions given in this book."



Apply Willpower to Yourself, not Others



Don't direct your energy and willpower toward influencing or changing others.

- *Do not impose your will on others*, e.g. take things from others, force them (mentally or physically) to do what you want them to do, or even insist they do something "for their own good".
- Likewise, *don't try to project your will out into space*, or insist the Source delivers something in a certain way. This will only create negative impressions that negate your positive requests.



Instead, use your willpower on yourself.

- Use the energy to *clarify your mental picture* and impress it on the Source. Then, let the Source chart the best path to attain those goals. Once you know what to think and do, use your willpower to force yourself to think and do those things.
- What you notice and think about will shape your beliefs. Use your willpower to *focus only on what you want*. If you want to get rich, do not think of your past financial struggles, complain to others about your problems, or envy others for their wealth and fame. Spend your time, energy and attention now on the things you want to create.
- The best way to *address poverty* is not to fight it or even sacrifice what you have for charity. It is to get rich yourself, inspire/educate others to become rich, and focus on new ways to create riches for yourself and the world. Treat poor people with joy and respect (not with pity), as if they're already becoming rich, and inspire them to find their own way to riches.



Part 3: Acting in the Certain Way

The Source sets things in motion by sending people, solutions and opportunities your way. **You'll need to take personal action**

KEY QUOTES

"You cannot retain a true and clear vision of your wealth if you are constantly turning your attention to opposing pictures."

"The poor do not need charity; they need inspiration."

"By thought, the thing you want is brought to you; by action you receive it."

to receive these gifts and convert them to money and riches. In so doing, remember not to take advantage of others or to give charity. Instead, give more use value than the cash value you receive.



Take Efficient Action



Taking efficient action means to “fill your present place”:

- You can only take action now, in the present. If there's something you can do now to create success, do it. Don't fret over the past or wait for things to happen in the future. Do all that you can today, every day.
- However, don't overwork or rush into work meant for the future (out of worry that you won't have enough time or opportunity). It's not about how much you do, but how efficiently you do them.
- The key is to ensure every small action you take is a success—if you do so, these will accumulate to make your entire life a success.



Most people set their intentions fervently, then end up taking action in a half-hearted, distracted way. Put 100% of your focus into whatever action you're currently taking, holding your vision as you perform your tasks.

- It won't work if you pray fervently once a week then forget about your vision. Everything you think, say, do must be aligned with your definite purpose.
- Have the faith and gratitude that what you're doing now is part of the process of delivering your vision.
- Use your leisure hours to contemplate your vision so it gets even clearer, more definite, and deeply lodged in your mind.



Getting into the Right Business



You can succeed in any area if you put your mind to it. However, it's generally easier to get rich and achieve success if you play to your strengths and focus on an area where you already have well developed talent.

KEY QUOTES

“Do, every day, all that can do that day, and do each act in an efficient manner.”

“Do all that you can do in a perfect manner every day, but do it without haste, worry, or fear. Go as fast as you can, but never hurry.”

“You can get rich in ANY business, for if you have not the right talent for you can develop that talent.”

- Wattles recommends that you start with a business or vocation that fits your inborn talents or existing skills.
- If you feel a strong desire for another business or vocation (but have no existing talent or skill for it), set it as an end-goal, and gradually develop your abilities while growing your wealth. No matter what new business or career you wish to venture into, you must start with your current work.



It's common to start doing something, then realize that it's **not what you really want**, or it may even be something you hate to do.

- In such cases, don't force yourself to keep doing it, unless it's a means to get to an end.
- However, don't rush into decisions or quit immediately. Spend 1-2 days contemplating the vision of what you want—get connected with the Source, so you know the right action to take. You may very well find new ways to improve your current situation and grow yourself.



Advancement



Every human being has an innate desire for advancement and to express himself/herself more fully. Thus, we seek greater wealth and are attracted to those who can give us a more abundant life. You attract people when you **seek advancement** both for yourself and for others.

- Show that you're making progress in everything that you do, that you're confident of getting rich and can help others to get rich too. This will naturally draw customers and followers to you.
- Being confident is not the same as boasting or bragging about your success. As you gain influence and wealth, don't give in to the temptation to exert power over others, or compete with them to prove your worth/success.



Regardless of whether you're running your own business or holding a job, embrace the concept of **continuous advancement**.

KEY QUOTES

"You will get rich most easily in point of effort, if you do that for which you are best fitted; but you will get rich most satisfactorily if you do that which you WANT to do."

"You are a creative center, from which increase is given off to all."

"Do everything that you do in the firm conviction that you are an advancing personality, and that you are giving advancement to everybody."

- Aim to more-than-fill your current place. When you become too big for your current role, you'll naturally progress to the next level.
- Take every opportunity to be more than you are now, and do it not to please others but to improve yourself.



Live and Spread the Truth

The Science of Getting Rich is essentially built on this simple truth—that you can generate any thought and impress it on the Source to cause it to take concrete form.



When you embrace this truth and know you can create whatever you want, you will no longer fear scarcity and competition.



Unfortunately, this truth contradicts most of what we see and hear around us. To think in a way that'll make you rich, you must focus only on the truth, regardless of how things appear to be.

- Put aside whatever you know or think you know about the universe, money, and wealth. Stop reading or watching any material that contradicts the truths in this book.
- Instead, keep reading and contemplating the statements below until you know them by heart and believe 100% that they are true.

“There is a thinking Stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

A thought, in this Substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

In order to do this, man must pass from the competitive to the creative mind; he must form a clear mental picture of the things he wants, and do, with faith and purpose, all that can be done each day, doing each separate thing in an efficient manner.”

KEY QUOTES

“There is no such thing possible in this universe as a lack of opportunity for the man who is living the advancing life.”

“The men and women who practice the foregoing instructions will certainly get rich; and the riches they receive will be in exact proportion to the definiteness of their vision, the fixity of their purpose, and steadiness of their faith, and the depth of their gratitude.”



Live and spread the truth, so you become rich and also help others to get rich.

- Existing governments and people in power may try to keep the masses ignorant and in poverty. However, no institution or system can stop you from becoming rich if you follow the truths in this book.
- When there are enough people advancing and becoming rich, entrenched systems (that perpetuate scarcity and poverty) will naturally change.



Other Details in the Book to Look out For

This is a relatively thin book, presented in short chapters. Wattles reinforces the key ideas above in various ways to help us understand the abstract concepts and how to apply them in real-life. He promises that if you truly grasp the science in this book (like how you grasp the concept of addition or subtraction), then this will be the only book on getting rich that you will ever need.

KEY QUOTES